establishments, and indeed the nomadic visitors' participation to varying degrees in the *khanaqah*'s activities – for example, *dhikr*, *urs*, or other gatherings – historically would have represented one of the principal avenues of exposure to an array of Islamicate socio-religious practices, and perhaps even the totality of some of these groups' actual knowledge of "Islam" and its associated architecture.[95] It is thus conceivable that, through their interactions with even minor architectural complexes, nomadic/transhumant visitors would gain at least a cursory apprehension of current styles, some among them also perceiving the buildings' more immediate functions and even their larger political implications.

Such regular seasonal, architectural, and urban interactions would have contributed little, however, toward deepening knowledge of the Qur'an and its exegetical traditions among groups such as the Shansabanis, or giving them comprehensive training in Persian literary history and composition.[96] In fact, taking into account their limited familiarity with Persianate courtly cosmopolitanism, it is understandable – rather than remarkable – that virtually no Persian inscriptions appeared on the imperial Shansabanis' buildings; their predilections naturally tended toward a select and effectively reduced group of Qur'anic verses and simple doxologies, which were by default in Arabic.[97] The differences between the rulers and at least some of their courtiers with regard to Qur'anic and exegetical conversancy would have to be bridged, then, in the course of selecting verses, Hadiths or other theologically significant material as part of devising architectural epigraphy. The religious and intellectual experts in the Firuzkuh Shansabanis' retinues and court would have conceivably made the initial selections from appropriate sources, even if these were pending the approval of their patron(s).

In the end, both in the historical moment and in hindsight, it accrues to the Shansabanis' credit that they understood and enacted, with great responsiveness, the urgency of building monumentally for an emerging transregional elite such as themselves: commissioning and endowing "civic" institutions was an effective way of commanding and mobilizing labor in their areas of control, even without erecting palaces. The actual fruits of this expenditure of resources, namely, the prominent architectural complexes centering and sustaining their environs, were not only attestations of economic wherewithal, they were also the most efficacious means of monitoring and eventually controlling legal thought and practice, which are among the very mechanics of empire along with military might and commercial prosperity. In the case of the Firuzkuh Shansabanis, the age-old Khurasani commercial networks and prosperous urban centers remained part of their architectural–cultural *habitus*; it is all the more noteworthy, then, that they apparently persisted in their preference of tent over palace, continuing their seasonal migrations between their summer and winter encampments or "capitals."